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Name of the book : THUNDERGOD: THE ASCENDANCE OF INDRA

Author :RAJIV G MENON

Rating : 3.47 out of 5

THUNDERGOD: THE ASCENDANCE OF INDRA



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LIST OF CHARACTERS



Indra

The protagonist and the son of Dyaus and Prithvi, known as the God of Thunder and War



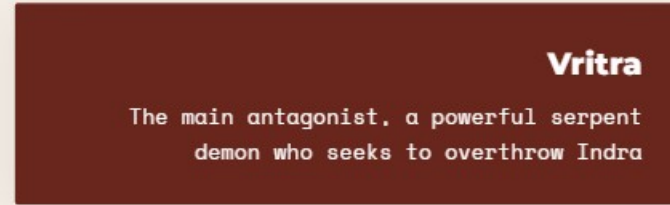
Agni

The God of Fire and a close ally of Indra



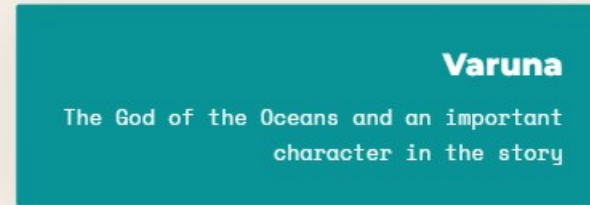
Sachi

Indra's wife and the goddess of beauty and fertility



Vritra

The main antagonist, a powerful serpent demon who seeks to overthrow Indra



Varuna

The God of the Oceans and an important character in the story



Brihaspati

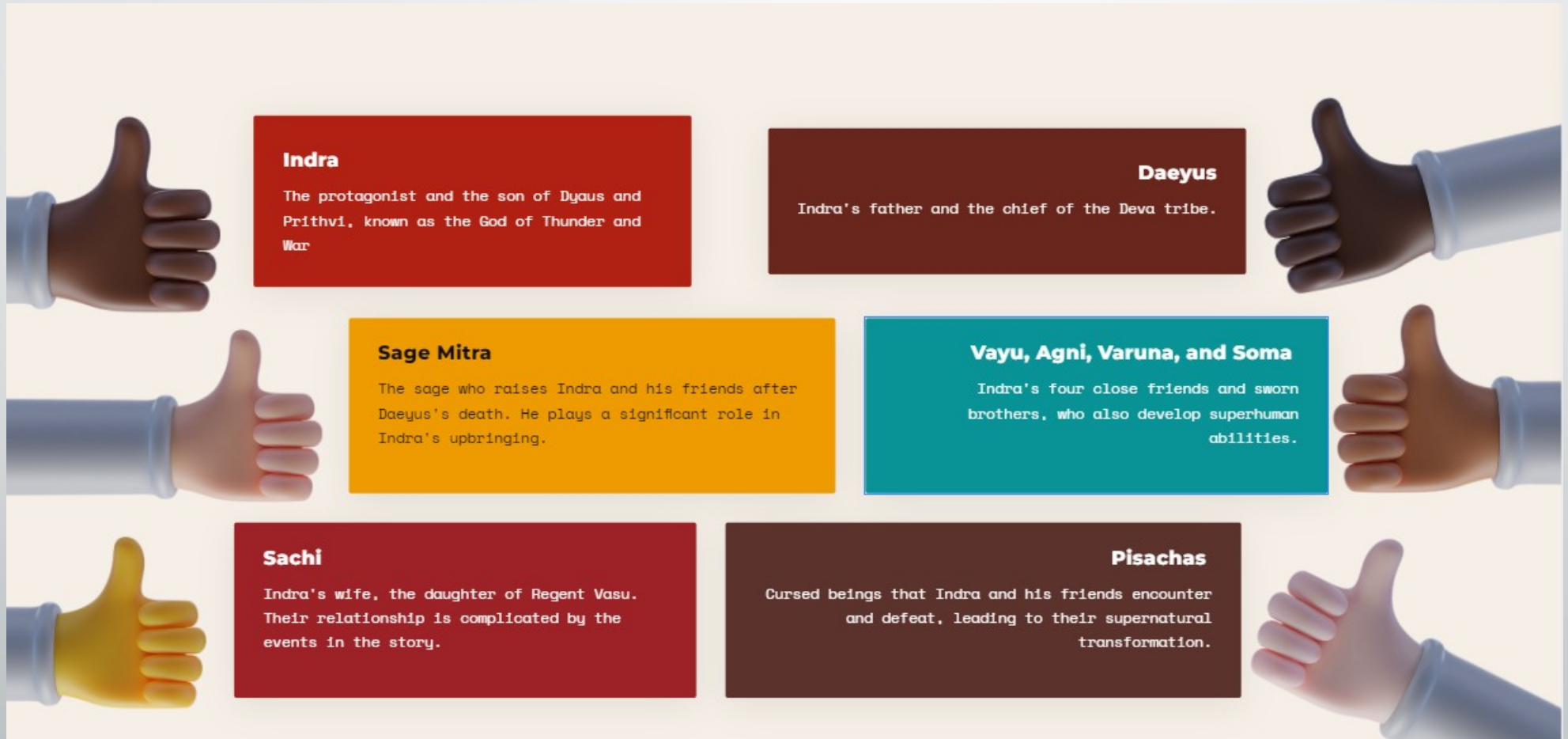
The Guru of the Devas and a wise counselor to Indra



List of characters

- **Indra:** The protagonist of the story, the god of thunder and rain, and the central character around whom the narrative revolves.
- **Daeyus:** Indra's father and the chief of the Deva tribe.
- **Sage Mitra:** The sage who raises Indra and his friends after Daeyus's death. He plays a significant role in Indra's upbringing.
- **Vayu, Agni, Varuna, and Soma:** Indra's four close friends and sworn brothers, who also develop superhuman abilities.
- **Sachi:** Indra's wife, the daughter of Regent Vasu. Their relationship is complicated by the events in the story.
- **Pisachas:** Cursed beings that Indra and his friends encounter and defeat, leading to their supernatural transformation.
- **Asuras:** Powerful adversaries and a constant threat to the Devas, including Indra.

List of characters



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- **Devas:** The tribe to which Indra belongs, and the gods of Hindu mythology.
- **Adityas:** A group of deities associated with Aditi, a mother of the gods, and a reference to a specific group of Hindu gods.
- **Yavanas:** A tribe mentioned in the story and one of the groups Indra is prophesied to unite.
- **Ikshvaakus:** Another tribe mentioned in the narrative.
- **Gaia:** The Earth Goddess and a celestial being with whom Daeyus has a relationship.
- **Harappans:** Inhabitants of the city of Harappa, which Indra attacks and conquers in the story.
- **Danavas:** Portrayed as dragons, they are an obstacle that Indra and the Devas must face.

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Summary

- Genre: Mythological Fantasy
- Author: Rajiv G. Menon
- A reinterpretation of the character of Indra, the god of thunder and rain, blending mythology and history.
- Follows Indra's journey from birth, his upbringing by a sage, and his transformation into a divine being with extraordinary powers.
- Explores themes of power, destiny, friendship, and the complexity of divine characters.
- Combines mythology with historical events, such as the conquest of the city of Harappa.
- Criticized for explicit content and language choices, but praised for character complexity and engaging storytelling.
- An imaginative and thought-provoking narrative offering a fresh perspective on Indian mythology and history

Theme and symbol used

- **THEMS:**

- **Myth and History:** The novel seamlessly merges Indian mythology with historical events, reimagining the legendary figure of Indra.
- **The Quest for Power:** Indra's unwavering desire for power shapes his character and drives the narrative's action.
- **Destiny and Prophecy:** The story revolves around a prophecy, highlighting the influence of fate on the characters' choices.
- **Friendship and Loyalty:** The strong bond between Indra and his friends underscores the significance of companionship in times of adversity.
- **Coming of Age:** The narrative traces Indra's transformation from a vulnerable child to a powerful leader, symbolizing his journey of self-discovery.

- **Symbols:**

- **Thunder and Rain:** Indra's control over thunder and rain symbolizes his power and authority as a god.
- **Golden Hair:** Indra's golden hair emphasizes his Eurasian roots and unique lineage.
- **Prophecy:** The recurring theme of prophecy symbolizes the influence of fate and destiny on the characters' lives.
- **Supernatural Abilities:** The transformation of mortals into divine beings with supernatural powers symbolizes their evolution and transcendence of human limitations.
- **Harappa:** The conquest of Harappa symbolizes historical events and Indra's role in shaping ancient history.

Reasons for likes and dislikes

- **LIKES:**

- I appreciate the novel's unique reinterpretation of the god Indra, offering a fresh perspective on a familiar mythological figure
- The complexity of Indra's character, with his strengths and flaws, resonated with me, making the story more engaging.
- The book provides an immersive cultural exploration of ancient India, allowing me to delve into its rich myths and traditions.
- Rajiv Menon's storytelling is captivating, and the well-described action sequences and battles kept me engrossed.

- **DISLIKE:**

- The initial avoidance of native language terms and Western influence in the narration was somewhat off-putting, as I expected a more authentic cultural experience.
- While I appreciated the sensuality in some parts, I felt that the explicit content was at times excessive, taking away from the overall narrative.

Conclusion

- "Thundergod: The Ascendance of Indra" is a thought-provoking and imaginative reimagining of Indian mythology and history. Its unique reinterpretation of the god Indra and seamless blending of mythology and history offer a fresh perspective on a beloved figure. While the novel's character complexity and engaging storytelling are notable strengths, its explicit content, language choices, and historical deviations may not resonate with all readers. Ultimately, the book's appeal lies in its ability to spark a renewed interest in Indian mythology and its capacity to challenge our understanding of traditional tales.



Thank you